FROM LAP TO TAP · RE-ENTRY

THE TWO-MINUTE RETURN

A one-on-one conversation when a student comes back to class after Tap In or Tap Out. It follows the same four steps as every response, action, impact, correction, return, and it ends with the student working.

WHEN
Right at the return, once the student is calm. The class keeps working on a task that runs on its own.

WHERE
Side by side, out of the spotlight. Never at the front of the room or across the room.

TONE
Calm, short, and warm. The conversation is about getting back to learning, not adding a consequence.

TIME	SAY	DO
0:00 RECONNECT	**RECONNECT** **"Welcome back. I'm glad you're here."** **"I want you in this class."**	Side by side at the door or a quiet spot, not in front of peers. Calm voice. The first words are about the relationship, not the incident.
0:15 ACTION	**ACTION** **"Tell me what happened, from your side."** **"What I saw was [only what was seen and heard]."**	Listen without interrupting. Then name the action in one sentence. No retelling, no lecture, no labels.
0:45 IMPACT	**IMPACT** **"What did that do to the learning?"** **"Yours, or someone else's?"**	Let the student name it. If the student cannot, name it once: "It stopped the lesson for the class."
1:15 CORRECTION	**CORRECTION** **"Next time you feel that way, what will you do instead?"** **"Let's pick a signal you can use."**	Agree on one specific replacement: hand up, a break card, asking for water, a quiet signal to the teacher.
1:45 RETURN	**RETURN** **"Here is where we are. Start at number [__]."** **"I'll check on you in five minutes. Clean slate."**	Point to the exact entry point on the task. Walk the student to the seat. Come back when promised.

IF THE CONVERSATION STALLS

- **If the student is still upset,** "We'll talk in five minutes. Start here for now." Give a task first and hold the conversation once the student is calm.
- **If the student says "I don't know",** Offer two choices: "Was it more like this, or more like that?"
- **If the student blames someone else,** "I'll talk with them too. Right now I'm asking about your part."
- **If the student apologizes,** Accept it simply and move straight to the return. No speech.

AVOID, AND DO AFTER

- Avoid re-arguing the incident, asking "why," or requiring a public apology.
- Avoid adding a new consequence in the conversation. The ladder already did its work.
- Within the period, give one precise, positive contact on something the student did right.
- Document the return and the agreed replacement on the lap tracker.